Ford Motor Company

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48121
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan

March 2002

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Emissions Recall 02E18: Certain 2000 Model Year Lincoln LS vehicles with 3.9L V8 Engines - Thermostat Replacement

REF: Dealer Announcement dated October 2001, Special Handling Procedure

REF: Dealer Announcement dated May 10, 1999, Low Volume Programs

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 Model Year Lincoln LS vehicles with 3.9L V8 Engines built at the Wixom Assembly Plant from March 22, 1999 through June 16, 1999.

REASON FOR THIS RECALL

During the manufacture of the thermostats for the affected vehicles, a stress condition may have been induced in the brass top strap. When exposed to coolant, pressure, and high temperature, this condition may lead to stress corrosion cracking of the top strap and eventual failure of the thermostat. If the thermostat fails, it will be stuck in the closed position, causing the engine to overheat and potentially affecting vehicle emissions.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this Emissions Recall, the dealer must replace the thermostat. This must be done on all of the affected vehicles in dealer inventory as well as vehicles that have been delivered to customers.

NOTE: The State of California and the Commonwealth of Massachusetts require the completion of emission recall repairs prior to vehicle registration renewal. For vehicles registered in these states, please provide the owner with a Vehicle Emission Recall Proof of Correction certificate after the repair has been performed. (These certificates may be obtained by contacting your regional office.)

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SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all Lincoln LS owners affected by this program. Please see dealer announcement dated October 2001, Special Handling Procedure. This special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer owners convenient vehicle handling.

Lincoln Mercury is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for our Lincoln LS customers, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

LOW VOLUME PROGRAM

This recall is being processed as a Low Volume Program. This type of field action was announced in an All-Dealer letter dated May 10, 1999.

Owners will be contacting the Low Volume Coordination Center to arrange for this service. We will advise you via CuDL (Customer Data Link) of the owners that chose your dealership to perform the service provided by this recall. The parts will be ordered for you by the Program Coordination Center.

You are requested to contact the owner and arrange for this service. (Note that our Coordination Center will advise owners that they will hear from you within the next two business days.)

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I:	Administrative Information
Attachment II:	Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III:	Technical Information
Customer Letter(s)	

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information: ……1-800-423-8851
Other Recall (Dealers Only) Questions: ……1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this Emissions Recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Online Involved Unit Listing available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other affected vehicles identified in OASIS which are brought to your dealership.

You must contact the Low Volume Coordination Center at 1-800-248-0186 to arrange for parts if you have an involved vehicle in stock. When calling this number, identify Emissions Recall 02E18 and have the VIN of the dealer stock vehicle to be serviced.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Note: Owners should receive the "Special Handling Procedure". To familiarize yourself, please review "Special Handling Procedure" before calling customers.

When you receive notification through CuDL (Customer Data Link), you should contact the owner and arrange for this service. Please note that our Coordination Center will advise owners that they will hear from you within the next two business days. For more information, see "Low Volume Announcement Letter" dated May 10,1999.

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

NOTE: These dealer listings may contain customer names and addresses obtained from Motor Vehicle Registration Records. The use of such motor vehicle registration data for any purpose other than in connection with this field service action is a violation of law in several states/provinces/countries. Accordingly, limit the use of this listing to the follow-up necessary to complete this action.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

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CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

To claim for "Special Handling", follow the instructions on page two of dealer announcement dated October 2001.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the owner letter (or after the date of the owner letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer.) Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Replace Thermostat & refill cooling system	02E18B	0.9** Hours
Special Handling*	Misc. Expense Code "SCHP"	See Special Handling
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

* Does not apply to dealer stock units
** The above time differs from published time because no diagnosis is required.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS / ORDERING INFORMATION

CUSTOMER VEHICLES:

Parts will be shipped to your dealership according to the procedures established for "Low Volume Programs". DO NOT order parts, except for dealer stock units (Refer to "Low Volume Programs").

Note: When the customer calls the Coordination Center, the correct parts will be automatically sent to the Dealer. A DOES II message will be sent to the Dealer confirming part shipment. Parts not used may be returned for credit. (See "Excess Stock Return" below).

STOCK VEHICLES:

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. First, count the number of vehicles to determine parts requirements. Then, contact the Low Volume Coordination Center at 1-800-248-0186 to arrange for parts. When calling this number, identify Emissions Recall 02E18 and have the VIN of the dealer stock vehicle to be serviced.

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through order processing channels as noted below:

All Order Types	First 121 days after launch	Call 1-800-248-0186
All Order Types	121 days after launch	Normal order process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
XW4Z-8575-CA	Thermostat Assembly	1
VC-4-A (6 gallons)	Engine Coolant top off	1 (1 gallon)
FPS-8262	Authorized Modifications Label*	1

***** Label orders come in packages of 25.

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ORDER INFORMATION

The DOR/COR for this program is 50269. This number identifies parts ordered for this Emissions Recall through the Low Volume Coordination Center (1-800-248-0186).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to DOES II or updated price book.

PARTS RETENTION

Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for “Parts Retention and Return

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

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